

Blurry monitor

Q I have a Pentium III 866 MHz CPU with 128 MB RAM. For the past few months, I have noticed that the display gets blurry a few minutes after I turn my computer on. This happens with all the three OS I run.

If I turn my monitor off for half an hour, I get a sharp picture for a few seconds after I turn it on again. Kindly suggest a solution.

Alip Kumar Saha

A As the problem persists in all the



the problem still persists, then get the picture tube of your monitor checked from your vendor.

three OS', the problem rests either with your display adapter, or your monitor. First, try uninstalling your display adapter drivers and then re-install them. If

amount of size. The difference in the disk consumption shown and as assumed by you is because you are not considering the size of the hidden files.

In order to check if you are indeed consuming 3.77 GB of space, in Windows Explorer go to **View > Folder Options**. Select 'Show all files' and press OK. Now go to the C drive, select all files and check the total usage of disk space by right-clicking on it and selecting Properties. This will confirm the amount of space you are using.

DirectX misbehaving

Q I have a P4 1.7 GHz computer, 128 MB DDR RAM, running Windows XP. I have a problem running my games. I tried the DirectX diagnostic troubleshooting tool, and found that there is some sort of DirectX error. When I ran the Direct3D test, a message is displayed saying, "You cancelled the test by pressing a key", even though I never touched any key. I installed DirectX 8.1 from one of the earlier Digit CDs, but even that didn't help. I tried to repair Windows XP, which solved the problem, but only for a few days. I have Windows XP and 2000, and the problem persists with both the operating systems. Please help me.

Suman

A It seems that some application is modifying settings in your computer that is preventing or disabling DirectX from functioning properly. What you can do is restore your computer using the System restore feature. Then check if DirectX functions properly, and if you are able to carry out the diagnostic tests. Then install the applications that you normally would. Check after each application or game installation, if the DirectX functionality remains. If you face this problem after installing a game, then the game is to blame. An easier way around this is to download and install the latest DirectX 9. It will upgrade your version of DirectX and also fix any corrupted, or missing files.

Send your computing problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write to Digit, D-222/2, TTC Industrial Area, MIDC, MIDC, Nerul, Navi Mumbai-400 706, and we may answer it here!

from each of the HTML files manually. If you miss even a single file, it will spread again.

Aging battery

Q I have a Pentium 4 1.7 GHz with a SiS chipset motherboard, with Windows 98 SE and 2000 installed. When I start my computer in Windows 98, the logo remains for a long time, but then the machine starts normally.

I also have another problem. The CMOS system password works until an error occurs or I restart the PC. Then it displays a message 'CMOS checksum error defaults loaded'. I think it is due to the low power in CMOS battery, even though it displays the time correctly. What can be the problem?

Shiladitya Mohapatra

A Normally, Windows loads applications after the boot up process. If your PC takes a long time to start, it is because of the device drivers and files loading in the background. You can also use the Msconfig utility in Windows to disable all background programs that may affect your Windows startup time. After you have reached the Windows desktop, perform these steps below

Click on **Start > Run**. Type '**MSCONFIG**' to get a window with a title 'System Configuration Utility'. Click on the Startup tab. Here you will see a list of programs installed on your computer. These are programs that load automatically when Windows is started, and they keep running in the background. Please clear all the check boxes except for 'ScanRegistry' and 'SystemTray', then click OK. The computer will now prompt you to restart. This should help you reduce some of the

startup time taken by Windows.

Regarding your second query, it seems that your CMOS battery has drained out. Even though it shows the correct time, it will decrease over a period of time. We recommend you to replace it.

Exaggerated disk usage

Q I have a PC with Pentium 4 processor, 845E mercury motherboard, 256 MB RAM, 40 GB Seagate hard disk and Windows 2000 Professional. The problem is that my machine shows my disk usage more than it actually is, i.e., I use 2.11 GB, but it shows that I use 3.77 GB. The partition size is 9.31 GB. Can you tell me why Windows extrapolates my disk usage?

Ramprasad

A Windows is not extrapolating your disk usage; in fact, your OS is showing the exact



Remember to select hidden files as well if you want to know the exact hard disk space usage